

Private Worship Vol IV - 2

Love Turns the Imagination Toward Eternal Things

I was preaching to myself about soaring eagles, miracles, and places in God not visited, places available. I had a time. When I get out there, and some of you do not go with me, I know you are having a good time because I am. But when I am out there like that, I see certain things.

I get to see things that usually are impossible, absolutely impossible. I used to think in terms of impossibility, in the areas of what I could have or not have, because I did not know I was a baby then.

One time I was preaching on the love walk, and I thought I would use one of those little parables to make a point. I said, "One time I was getting ready to leave and go preach a meeting on love, and my son was out there. I told him to do something, but he did not do it, so I got him in an airplane spin and threw him against the brick wall. His little body flopped down and rolled out on the ground. I shook him until he came to, and I told him, 'I am going to preach on love for three days, but when I get back, you had better be out in the yard doing what I told you.'"

This lady on the front row yelled, "Oh my God!"

I said, "Lady, you have got to be kidding. That was a parable."

Sometimes I will see things, and they are impossible. I do not want the same things I used to. It seems like for Him to turn you, I know it is a mortification process, but it really is the inner man taking on all that God is and taking over the outer man.

One neglected attribute is the love of God, which will manifest itself in compassion. A person will usually quit sinning pretty well because he falls in love with God too much. But when that love starts manifesting, then you start loving more of the things God loves and less of the things men love.

You start loving more what He loves and the truth that will come around to people.

John Shows That Perfected Love Casts Out Torment and Fear

John, who walked in it the longest, probably outlived the emperor Domitian. He came back from Patmos after receiving the book of Revelation at about a hundred years old. He had been doing physical labor at the bottom of a mine in a penal colony just off Turkey. They sent prisoners there, and John outlived the man who sent him.

When he came back, he started ministering at Ephesus and throughout other churches in Asia Minor. Young men would hold him on each arm, this is history, and he would always preach about the capacity of God's love flowing through you. He said it is really His love that will take care of

everything else, because if creation does not respond to it, it is people God takes care of, because He takes care of you.

Jesus said that by this shall they know you are His disciples, that you love one another.

Then John threw in the benefit. John could testify after being through so much. They tried to put him to death as a martyr, and he would not die. Boiling oil did not work. He just came back up out of it, and that was it.

He said this kind of love casts out torment and fear. The only way you can have absolutely no torment and fear is not to be afraid of anything. He said this man is being perfected in God. The measuring stick is freedom from torment and fear.

When God's love is amplified in a person, then you start loving what God loves. He will slowly make you transition to eternal things. The funny thing is that when you finally do get things, you will probably see them for what they are worth, so they are not able to hold the place in your life that God is supposed to hold.

You start seeing eternal things as really, really important. Jesus said a man has gained nothing if he gains everything that perishes, such as the world, and loses his soul. What good does it do you after the first hundred years?

Loving what God loves, more and more, I am getting to look down the path at more eternal things, which always ends up being people. You cannot find any throwaway people.

Redemption Leaves No Throwaway People

You may say, "That person has a record of being ugly and mean."

Who would you compare him to? Stalin? Lenin? Hitler?

When I passed through this part in revelation knowledge about His love, redemption became a real final thing to me. You do not want to sow just a little seed, hoping for some kind of skimpy harvest somewhere along the way. It is hard for you to have faith for people unless somewhere down the line you fall in love with them just a little through His eyes.

Are you going to get the faith for a real harvest if you never come to the place where you love people? Where are you going to get the faith?

If Hitler were in heaven, some believer would go up and indict him: "What are you doing here? I happen to know what you did."

If they complained to Jesus, He would check the records. He would say, "Yes, there was a Hitler. He was born on the earth. Yes, this Hitler did those things, but he has already been punished for them."

"Wait a minute. He accepted Jesus, so Jesus stepped in and was punished in his place. That man does not exist anymore. A new creation has come into place, and this new creation is the son of God. None of those war crimes are on the account of this man. The man who did those things has already been punished in Him."

He does not really have any throwaway people, just people who have not accepted the judgment that has been laid on Jesus in their place.

Jesus said, "I judge no man." The Father judges no man. All judgment is committed to the Son. Why? Because every human being has been judged in the Son.

We were all lost. His love was commended toward us with no guarantee that you would ever be born again, although it was God's will. He is not willing that any should perish. As you can see, sovereignty as taught in some camps is wrong. He does not always get His way. The part that is sovereign is the provision that, when you connect with it, will do what it said it will do. That is why you can have faith.

He did not want any to perish. Yet He commended His love toward you and went ahead and died. There was no guarantee that you would be saved, but it was okay. Whatever your life consisted of, from deplorable to civilization-destroying, the degrees do not matter. The Father judges no man for what you have done, because all judgment was committed to the Son. The Father judged the Son in every person's place, whether that person received Him or not.

Tongues Feeds Revelation While Worship Fills the Reservoir of Love

The further I journey into God, particularly in the private worship limb, the more I understand what I did not understand when I began it and locked myself up against the odds.

My spirit, being created after God, was full of diversities. One part craved knowledge. It could now discern and understand spiritual things, things that come right out of the mind of God. But another part seemed to be created to hold God's love and pool compassion.

In the same way that I feed the hunger for knowledge by increasing in discerning who God is and His knowledge, there is a way to increase the reservoir that holds and pools God's compassion. One cannot give you what the other does, and the other cannot give you what the one does. But both can give you something that will launch your rocket.

I know how to feed my craving for knowledge. Praying in tongues is a revelation gift.

These great men who established the canon of Scripture, most of them had sixty-seven years establishing what they had to say. John probably had eighty years, and just five chapters are full of the mind of God, revelation knowledge, and permanency in the foundation of the body of Christ. They are worthy of a whole lot more than an occasional skimming to take a verse out of context to prove your point.

The same Holy Spirit who gave it to them has been given to me. He taught them, discerned it for them, and caused them to understand it. He stepped down into you and me, and His mission has not changed. He wants to guide us into all truth.

When we do not really know how to pray for ourselves, He steps in with the revelation gift, praying in tongues. You can pray thousands of hours of the mind of Christ up just to be answered in time. You begin to discern and understand God. The canon comes alive. Old Testament and New Testament fall into place in harmony because you understand the perspective in which they were written.

That is a tremendous part of my spirit: discerning God and equipping my faith. But just like in your humanity, one part loves and another part craves knowledge. In the DNA of your spirit, your birth from God, you have a reservoir. Before, you could not hold compassion. There was no capacity. Now that you have been made a partaker of His divine nature, there is an attribute in your spirit that was not there and could not be there before.

Just as praying in tongues fuels and increases my discernment of God, worship in private, suspending your human spirit in God's presence for hours if you want to, increases the love of God and the sanctification of the flesh.

Compassion Makes Cities and People Look Like God Sees Them

All of you are going to make it right where you are sitting. You do not have to do anything. It is all right. If I ever put you under condemnation, it is not my intent. My intent is to take Tulsa home with me. It is not to condemn you.

I just know that if the life of God were operating in the church where it should be operating, this task would be a whole lot closer to done than it is now. But it is obvious that if we are going to receive something we have never received before, we are going to have to do something we have never done before.

Now I am finding out that as I increase the reservoir, the part of my spirit that can hold the love of God, I am starting to think and look at humanity and cities more like He does. That is the part being increased right now.

A person cannot argue with the fact that Jesus mainly was moved by compassion. Where does a person get compassion? Compassion is a fruit, an attribute of agape. Agape is an attribute and capacity in your born-again spirit. Increase it, and after a year or so of it, I can tell you the result is to walk among sinners and start looking at them as the single most valued possession God has.

Let me use a computer-nerd illustration. What does a computer nerd crave? Knowledge. If he were chanting, this is what you would hear: "Knowledge, knowledge." The keyboard is smoking. Nothing satisfies him like getting into something where he is not supposed to be. His body is almost left out.

Then they transfer in nerd girl, walking down the hallway in her little cotton dress and pink sweater, one button in the wrong hole, little socks, thick glasses, and she is going, "Knowledge, knowledge." Computer nerd catches a glimpse of her out of the corner of his eye, and suddenly, "This magic moment..." From then on, that part of his creation craves something that can only be found in her presence.

One part of me craves knowledge, but I have found a pool in my spirit that has the capacity to hold and overflow the love and compassion of God. It cannot be satisfied with knowledge. I have found that what I am looking for can only be found in His presence.

I knew God would have to do something. I knew He would have to show me something. Wouldn't you know that when His love is activated in you, it would be eternal things and people? Wouldn't you know that when you start loving with His love, it would have to do with these things?

Where does faith come from for cities?

Love Changes the Outlook and Strengthens Faith for Miracles

When I told you I saw things this morning, I did. I left things behind and went on. I was having a glorious time. He was ministering to me the reality of what I was seeing.

I am having the best time with verses like, "All things are possible to him that believeth." I am having the best time with God taking the Word, unfolding it as absolute, infallible truth and proof that He is and will do everything He said He would do.

It was so strong on me about people who did not have teeth coming in by the next morning that I could not stand it. I kept saying, "If it gets any stronger, I feel like I am going to die." I meant that in a good sense: die from the goodness of His presence.

This nice lady came up and said, "Oh, Brother Roberson, that is a bad confession."

Okay. But the miracles.

What do you attribute it to? I do not even know how to tell you. The longer I suspend my spirit in God's presence, particularly in private worship because my spirit cannot find what it is looking for in the presence of anyone else, something has been happening to my faith. Something has been happening to what I do not know what else to call but compassion.

It has been changing my outlook with you. It seems I get to look at you more through His eyes. But even more than this, those things we call joy, peace, and contentment, the things that have to do with emotion, are changing.

It used to be that I had to lock up emotions that did not serve the kingdom. I would say, "You cannot come out and play today. You have to stay in the house." Who would I let out? The ones that agree with the Word. All the emotions that agree with the Word come out, and then an ugly one comes out. "You get back in there. You are supposed to be dead anyway."

It seems that the more you baptize yourself in His compassion, His love and joy, the more your emotions begin to serve God. You are supposed to count it all joy when you fall into different kinds of tests and trials. If some of you did not count it joy in your trials, you would not have any joy, would you?

Am I hinting at a place where you can let the emotions out? I am talking about a place where the emotions do not have to be locked up, where they really do serve God. They are free. You get up, and all hell can be exploding, and you do not have to get a hold of yourself. There is no fear, no turning. You just get up into a wonderful stillness.

"But your whole world is flying apart."

"I did not notice."

It is not that you do not care. The thing is, you do care. That is why you are not taking the care.

True Responsibility Refuses the Care That the Cross Already Took

I remember the early days of faith when somebody would say, "Take care." We would say, "I am not taking care." We thought it sounded like, "Burden yourself down with it. Take it." But what they were really saying, and we knew it inside, was, "I care about you. Be careful."

What that really means to a believer is to take care that God is holding the right place in what you are about to do. Pay attention.

Now I have found out that if I take the wrong kind of care, I cannot really take responsibility. The only way I can take true responsibility is by not taking the care, because the care of it has already been taken by the cross. It has been taken care of.

So the only way I can take true responsibility is by not taking the care of it. That does not seem like a place you can just put away in the natural. About the time you get a billion dollars and eight generations are secure, you start dying of some disease nobody can cure.

I found that I can take responsibility if I do not take the care. In other words, if I leave it with Him.

That is not a place where you just say, "I am going to get up today and walk in it." Of all the attributes of the soul, the hardest to turn is emotion, because emotions seem to have their own life. You say, "I have emotions." Usually, emotions have you.

Casting down imaginations means casting down systems of thought empowered by emotion, and those are hard to turn loose. Some of you get so emotional you have to find somebody to frame it on. You say, "You are ugly, so I am not coming here anymore." First you have the emotion: "I have to get out of here." Then you frame it.

Emotions usually have to be turned. Why am I saying all this? Because I am finding that the emotions you can let out of the house are the ones you find on the private worship limb, from suspending your spirit in His presence until compassion and the love of God start taking place.

The Same Love for God Must Become Love for People

What did Jesus say? When someone asked what must be done to enter the kingdom, He said, "You know the commandments." First, love the Lord your God with all your heart, mind, soul, and strength. The second is like the first: love your neighbor as yourself.

In other words, the same love you love God with is the same love you love your neighbor with.

"I am going to skip my neighbor and just love God."

It does not work that way. It is the same love. You can tell you are really developing in God's love because you are developing love toward people.

It usually begins with forgiving everything. They are ugly, and you forgive them, and forgive them, and forgive them. After a while it turns into compassion. You just feel so sorry that they are opposing themselves.

He said, "The same love you love Me with, love them with." The whole Ten Commandments hang on these two. The first four are loving God. The last six are loving your neighbor with the same love with which you love God.

It took me a while to find out that my love for God is not growing any faster than my love for people is growing. Every time you get a true increase in the love of God, there is a true increase of love for people.

Religion gets hard. It sacrifices people in the name of God. But life loves people by God.

Why am I saying all this? Because I am prophesying. If it were up to me, I would have another lesson. Good thing it is not. With my own lessons, I tend to love to major on your faults a whole lot more than He does.

Giftings Stop Where Flesh Remains Accepted

Why is this coming? That vision of the road ahead, where most people peel off, is staying right there. I cannot relax my mind for a minute without looking down at it again.

The giftings stop pretty much where the flesh is accepted. When the flesh ceases to be accepted, then usually the person possessing the gifting does not take the gifting any further down the road.

The only problem was that the greater place was farther down that road. When the mouth of it opened up, it opened up, and nobody wanted to go any further. God gave quite a lot to the mouth of that road. Most were satisfied with what He had given. Even though they could sense what was out there, they did not feel it necessary to pay the price to go on because they were getting apparently so much done in the place where they were walking.

There are a lot of people out there with strong giftings. I have counseled many people who have been destroyed by ministry. It took a while to put them back together. According to them, it was because of how they were treated.

I know people will go somewhere and tell people how bad I am, and that is the first time I find out about it. If I did those things to them, I do not know it. Unless I can discern things, sometimes I do not know whether they are telling the truth.

Sometimes I tell them, "I am only going to listen to all this bad stuff once, and then I will tell you who the problem is. It is you. It does not matter what they did to you. You still have a responsibility to respond correctly."

One thing I found out about Jesus: when He divided the fishes and loaves, He could just as easily have organized a camel train. He could have said, "Look over the mountain. Camel trains of food. Go take men and unload them and distribute them to the people." That is how we operate mostly.

But He did not organize a camel train. He took the boy's fish and loaves and fed them all. He is the Head of the church. He is our example. He said there is only one Teacher, only one Master, which is Jesus. That means there are other teachers, but if you are not teaching what He is teaching, you are not a teacher.

When man's system fails, His never does. As long as He has one person, that one person has all of heaven's supply.

Heaven Is Enough When Human Systems Break Down

When you stand in judgment, you are just standing there. If He happens to cover the late-bill department, if He happens to cover the ones you ran out on or filed bankruptcy on, then along with it He is going to show you the price He paid and where He paid your bill.

"Then why was it not paid?"

Because you did not get it. It does not mean He did not provide it.

If all of you got mad at me and Gary and said, "This is going nowhere. You do not know anything," it is still because we chose to take the journey in the Spirit so what we did get would never abort.

I know the building is worn out. It is mostly worn out from prayer. The building serves the people; people do not serve the building. We wore it out. We are taking a while to get a foundation, but we are never going to stop. We are never going to be stopped. This city is ours. It is as simple as that.

If everybody left, and God's method of operation, which He usually uses, broke down, where preachers go to people and people give them the money and they do what they do, He would still be enough.

He said He was not going to destroy the earth because of evil again. Next time He destroys the earth, He is going to have a new earth and evil will be removed, so He will not have the problem of filling the earth up again with evil men.

As long as there is a heaven and an earth, there will be seasons, hot and cold. He gave a bow as a sign. It is always going to rain, so the earth is always going to produce. There will be pestilences, earthquakes, and different things in different places. Things will happen, but the earth is pretty much going to produce because it works under law. You do not mess with those laws too much or make them uneven one way or another. They destroy.

That is God's method of operation. If I break a drought in India by the faith of God and feed everybody in a village, they are going to go back to eating off the land next year. I may want to come and put on another demonstration, but God would say, "What for? I fed them all with rain and seed. What is the matter with you, boy? There is a lot of disease on them. Major on that."

His method is for people to give and be blessed. The problem with Jesus coming to the end of the table with a bag of gold and doing it all for you all the time is that you do not have the privilege of developing your faith, your heart, your love, your compassion, and your giving. You have to develop that.

But if that system breaks down and there is nobody to help, you and heaven are enough. You can get Him to come and do anything.

This is what compassion has been doing. Every time I think I have it, it opens up more. I quit saying, "I got it." Now I am understanding that operating in the love He has for people is where the rest of it comes from: the supply, the cities. When God gets to come in on that, there is not anything He will not do.

Faith for Change Goes Beyond Faith for Things

Where is the faith in it? The faith is going there. Believing for cars and airplanes was easy compared to believing for the children to change and for change in my own character. Those things were easy, yet they can only take you so far.

Faith for change has no limit.

"I am just too weak to even want to."

That is why He invented tongues. You can sit there and pray in tongues while you hate the person on the row next to you. When you look at him, your body is killing him, but you are praying life.

If you want to quit changing, the best thing is to get rid of the people who are pestering you to change. Declare something bold over them and walk out, because it does not matter what your motive is. Motive is most of what praying in tongues works on.

If I pray in an unknown tongue, Paul said, my spirit prays. If it is my spirit praying, would it not stand to reason that it is my spirit that receives the answer to the prayer? All permanent change comes from within.

"I am ugly and no good, and I do not like to pray, and I only half believe in it."

It will still change you. Why? Because you just had the faith to stand there.

"I direct my prayer in tongues."

No, you do not. That is why He took the understanding away from you. You already messed things up. Let it go. You need His help. How about letting Him pick the prayer?

"Well, I am praying for this."

No, you are not.

"I want You to correct it."

He is praying for the correction in you so it will not come back.

Worship Offers Your Whole Self in a Language You Understand

Worship is when you fellowship with God in the language you communicate with. It begins out of the soul, in a legible language.

That is how you start in worship:

| Father, I glorify and magnify You.

The more you can pay attention, the quicker you will get in. When my mind wandered around, I was doing lip service. My mind was solving the problem from yesterday. My mind was way down the street, and my lips were saying, "I love You, I love You, I love You."

I made a point to get my mind, bring it back, and offer it up because I was in the presence of a King, and protocol is to bring a gift. I was the gift, my life. I did not have anything else He wants.

Going and getting your mind helps. It is faster. But if you do not, eventually it will wear down, and what you are saying out loud will eventually win anyway. But I can testify that the shortcut is to stop, go get your mind, and pour everything you are into every statement of adoration and worship.

So I cleared time to do that. I needed the time. I canceled meetings. I needed the time.

When He was able to minister to me, He made me understand by revelation that I had approached an area that was sacred, very sacred to hell. They could not let you pass into that holy ground without trying to stop you.

I said, "God, praying in tongues is just as dangerous, is it not?"

In no uncertain terms He told me yes, but most people abort long before they enter the gate of that kind of love and compassion God has. They abort long before that, so the enemy does not have to be as concerned about tongues unless you are consistent and simply will not stop. Then he will pull the best he has, and you will show him that God's best is better.

But this one he guarded like he was crazy. Too bad. If I have to line back up fifty times, I will line up fifty times. I have no quitting sense. I am going back.

Press Toward the High Call Without Condemnation

Is anybody having a good time? Stand up, throw your arms up, and worship a little.

Hallelujah, hallelujah. How I glorify You. I magnify Your holy name. I love You.

Some things belong to God. All the glory is one of them. I consider myself so blessed to get to go up to a gate like that and look in. So severely blessed. I got a taste of it, just enough to know I want more.

What kind of pastor would I be if I did not open that gate to you, in case some of you wanted to go?

You can stay where you are, go to heaven, and have some reward, I am sure. There is no condemnation. Nevertheless, once you have attained to something, walk therein, Paul said. He pressed toward the mark for the prize of the high calling of God in Christ Jesus. Yet he stopped and said, "Nevertheless, whatever you have attained to, walk therein."

Even though I am pressing, I take no condemnation for what I do not have or where I am walking. I take none. I just enjoy God. But why would I not press? There is a whole new world out there in God, a missionary front of harvesting burned-over fields that religion could not reach. Why would I stay here?

Condemnation does not mix with peace. I am not talking about conviction. Conviction is when you are visibly moved on by God to quit doing something ugly that you are doing. But you can give yourself condemnation from not thinking you are doing enough righteous things that you should be doing. There is not anybody I know who is not guilty of that.

So enjoy the heaven you have as you are going there. Do not take any condemnation. So what if you lose a week or two? Your life is not over. So what if you have a job in your way? Adjust it and believe God to pay you more for less. Then you get to go.

But everything changes when you start putting pressure on it. Everything changes. Nothing stays the same. You are the one who can change it in your favor.